



THE **REAL TIMES**

Real News in Real Time



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‘Justice delayed’

..LAZ says courts closure could negatively affect those requiring urgent judicial intervention

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‘Dogs evade pots’

By Alex Maboshe

Eleven dogs have been rescued from a suspected meat trade in Kabwe after police intercepted a truck which was carrying the animals on Saturday.

It was reported that upon stopping the vehicle, discovered 12 dogs inside, many of them in clear distress and one of the animals did not survive.

The Zambia Police Service immediately notified the Kabwe District Veterinary Office and Kabwe Animal Rescue, both of which responded promptly to assist at the scene.

The Lusaka Animal Welfare Society (LAWS) has confirmed the rescue stating that three of the surviving dogs are now in its care, while partner organisations are looking after the remaining animals.

LAWS expressed gratitude to the Zambia Police Service, Kabwe District Veterinary Office, Kabwe Animal Rescue, African Animal Rescue Centre and Showgrounds Vet Clinic for their rapid response and effective collaboration.

The rescued dogs are receiving veterinary care as authorities continue to investigate the circumstances of their transportation and intended destination.



Mazabuka teacher robbed, stabbed

By Alex Maboshe

A 29-year-old teacher was stabbed in the forehead and robbed of K47,000 after giving a lift to three strangers in Mazabuka District last evening.

Ian Makwaza, a resident of Changa-Changa Compound

and a teacher at Elevation Tuition Centre, was attacked at around 19:00 hours on the road leading to the Zambia Institute of Animal Husbandry (ZIAH).

Southern Province Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo confirmed the incident, which was reported at Mazabuka Police Station at

19:47 hours the same night.

According to Mr Namalongo, Makwaza had finished work and was driving towards ZIAH while carrying the cash when he encountered three unknown people, two men and one woman who asked for a ride, saying they were headed in the same direction.

“He agreed to give them a lift. After travelling about 300 metres, one of the male passengers allegedly stabbed Makwaza on the forehead with a screwdriver, inflicting a deep cut wound,” Mr Namalongo said.

“The vehicle was then stopped. The female passenger seized the teacher’s

bag containing the K47,000, and the three suspects fled the scene.”

Makwaza obtained a medical report for treatment. Police have opened a docket and launched investigations into the aggravated robbery.

No arrests have been made and the money has not been recovered.

“Investigations are ongoing, and further updates will be provided as the matter develops,” Mr Namalongo said.

The Zambia Police Service has appealed to members of the public with any information that could assist the probe to report to the nearest police station.

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‘Panic not, technical issues - Zesco’

Zesco has clarified that the power interruptions currently affecting some areas are caused by technical faults rather than

load-shedding. Speaking on the Phoenix Breakfast show today, Zesco Stakeholder Relations Manager

By Alex Maboshe

CEJ wants Environmental Court

By Ruth Kambita

The Centre for Environment Justice (CEJ) and its partners have intensified consultations to establish Zambia's first specialised environmental crimes court. The consultations, held in Serenje District, will contribute to a position paper to be submitted to the Judiciary, Ministry of Justice and Ministry of Green Economy and Environment. CEJ Executive Director Maggie Mapalo Mwape said the current court system lacked the capacity to handle complex environmental cases, leading to delayed justice for communities affected by pollution and land degradation. She said mining had brought economic benefits but had also caused serious social and environmental harm, citing Kabwe's lead-poisoning crisis and the 2025 Sino Metals tailings dam spill. Ms Mwape said a parliamentary motion and previous engagements with the Judiciary indicated

growing support for the proposed court. She said community views gathered during the consultation would be reflected in the final position paper, stressing that environmental justice must be timely and accessible. The meeting, held at Villambanadi Lodge, was supported under the five-year LIFT Zambia Project, funded by Norwegian Church Aid and Danish Church Aid. Serenje District Commissioner Ellen Miselo Mibenge expressed support for the initiative, saying the court would strengthen accountability and protect people and natural resources. Chief Chitambo urged CEJ to ensure that traditional leaders' views were included in the position paper. Environmental stakeholders have previously said specialised judicial expertise is needed to address pollution, ecological degradation and other complex environmental cases in Zambia.

Rose Sibisi said the country's electricity supply situation remains stable. She confirmed there are no plans to reintroduce load-shedding for the remainder of this year or into next year. Ms Sibisi explained that available generation is sufficient to meet present system demand. This contrasts with the 2024–2025 drought period, when hydroelectric sources accounted for 86 percent of the country's power. She noted that Zesco continues to supply customers nationwide while the network undergoes planned maintenance, upgrades and expansion works. Demand is rising steadily as new houses are built and businesses expand, she said, but the utility is matching this growth through ongoing projects. Ms Sibisi added that many faults are not reported promptly by customers, which delays the company's response and the restoration of supply. She urged members of the public to report outages as soon as they occur so that technicians can be deployed quickly.

By Sandra Chapa

The Law Association of Zambia (LAZ) has called for the urgent reopening of courts, warning that the continued closure could interfere with access to justice. In a statement issued today, LAZ president Arnold Kaluba expressed concern over the closure of courts and the presence of heavily armed military personnel around court premises in Mr Kaluba said some court premises had also been sealed off with tape marked "Crime Scene." He said LAZ was concerned that there had been no formal public explanation on the reasons for the closures, their scope or expected duration. "We are particularly concerned that, at the time of issuing this statement, there has been no formal public explanation outlining the reasons for the closures, their geographical scope, expected duration or arrangements being made to ensure continued access to justice," Mr Kaluba said. He said the closure could affect people requiring urgent judicial intervention,

including those with pending criminal proceedings, bail applications and habeas corpus applications. Mr Kaluba cited Article 13(3) of the Constitution, which requires arrested or detained persons who have not been released to be brought before a court without undue delay. LAZ also raised concern over the timing of the closures, coming during the seven-day period provided under Article 103(1) for challenging the presidential election. The association warned that the closure could disadvantage people seeking to file election petitions due to uncertainty over access to court registries and filing facilities. LAZ has called on the Judiciary to reopen the courts as soon as it is safe and practical, while putting alternative arrangements in place for urgent and time-sensitive matters. Mr Kaluba said LAZ was engaging Chief Justice Mumba

Malila and the Attorney General over the matter and would continue monitoring developments. Meanwhile, Alex Maboshe also reports that the Non-governmental Gender Organisations' Coordinating Council (NGOCC) has equally condemned the Judiciary of Zambia's unilateral closure of court premises nationwide, calling it unprecedented, unexplained and a threat to constitutional rights. In a statement issued today, Board Chairperson Ms. Beauty Katebe said the public has been left unable to access the courts, with no reopening timeline provided. NGOCC expressed particular alarm at the timing, which coincides with the constitutionally mandated seven-day period for filing a presidential election petition. Government today's circulated an internal memo to all members of the judicial staff not to report for work today as the premises would remain closed for security reasons.

Congolese in cannabis trafficking arrested

By Ruth Kambita

A 37-year-old Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) national, Modeste Kankonde, has been arrested at the Chirundu One-Stop Border Post for allegedly trafficking 2.3 kilograms of cannabis. Drug Enforcement Commission (DEC) Public Relations Officer Allan Tamba said Mr Kankonde was intercepted while travelling from South Africa and was reportedly destined for the DRC. In a separate arrest in Muchinga Province, 59-year-old Binwell Chanda of Mafinga District was detained after officers from a DEC and Zambia Police investigations team seized 18.5 kilograms of dry loose cannabis. The drugs were reportedly craftily wrapped in banana leaves and concealed in polythene bags in the Thendere area of Chilumbi village. DEC officers in the Southern Province also arrested 51-year-old peasant farmer Selina Mwalama of

Mwanajoke Village during an operation in Sinazongwe District, recovering 470 balls and 4.6 kilogrammes of loose cannabis. During the same operation, officers detained 28-year-old Lucky Siabusu, an assistant shopkeeper and relative of Mwalama, after he allegedly attempted to bribe officers with K5, 000 to secure her release. Siabusu has been handed over to the Anti-Corruption Commission (ACC) for further investigation. All suspects remain in lawful custody, Mr Tamba said, and will face court processes. He warned that border-control operations have been intensified and urged the public to remain vigilant, encouraging members of the public to report suspected illicit drug activity through established channels. "We will continue to arrest and prosecute those involved in trans-national drug trafficking," Mr Tamba said.

‘Suicide mission failed’

By Ruth Kambita

A Malawian man is hospitalised after allegedly attempting to take his own life by cutting his throat with a knife in Chipata District, Eastern Province. The incident occurred at about 15:00 on 22 August 2026 at Lufazi Village in the area of Chief Mpezeni. Michael Mbewe, who was driving a Toyota Hilux from the Jerusalem area towards Chaola Village, spotted the man by the roadside and saw him cutting his throat. Mr Mbewe said the man then ran towards his vehicle as if trying to be hit. He drove on and alerted police. Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said officers

rushed to the scene and found a man who gave his name as Ishmael, surname unknown, from Deza area in Malawi. Mr Mweemba said the man had a deep cut to his throat and was bleeding heavily. When questioned, the man reportedly told officers he wanted to commit suicide "to complete his mission." Mr Mweemba said the man had earlier gone to the home of Maureen Banda of Lufazi Village, where he asked to leave his bicycle. Ms Banda allowed him to leave the bicycle at her home, but he did not return. She later heard people shouting for help and discovered it was the same man. The injured man was taken to Mwami Mission Hospital and later referred to Chipata District Hospital.

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Security risk assessments launched

By Ruth Kambita

Inspector General of Police Graphel Musamba has revealed that the service has begun intelligence-led security risk assessments at selected key government premises across the country.

Mr Musamba said the move is aimed at safeguarding government institutions, public officers and members of the public accessing these facilities.

He said the operations, conducted in collaboration with other law enforcement and security agencies are preventive and seek to identify and address potential security vulnerabilities to prevent threats to public safety and the functioning of government institutions.

The assessments are targeting premises under the

Ministry of Justice, Ministry of Home Affairs and Internal Security, National Prosecution Authority, Attorney General's Chambers and other selected government departments and

institutions.

Mr Musamba stressed that the operation is not directed at any individual or group, but forms part of ongoing measures to strengthen pro-

tection at critical government sites and ensure the safety of persons and property.

He added that the exercises are being carried out professionally, lawfully and

in coordination with relevant security and law enforcement agencies.

Mr Musamba said the operation is ongoing, with the police promising to release

further information in due course. He has urged Members of the public to remain calm, cooperate with security personnel and comply with security instructions.

Man flees after abating girl

By Ruth Kambita

A man in Chasefu District is on the run after allegedly abducting a 16-year-old girl forcing her into marriage and administering an unknown substance to terminate her four-month pregnancy.

Gijibu Mtonga, now the suspect, allegedly abducted the Form One pupil from Beu Village on August 17, 2026, and took her to Chankhama Village, about 30 kilometres away.

The girl's father reported her disappearance to neighbourhood community personnel, who conducted a follow-up.

However, both the suspect and the victim had reportedly left the area and after realizing he had committed an offence, Mr Mtonga administered an unknown substance to the girl in an attempt to terminate her pregnancy.

He later took her to her aunt's home in Mpili Village, under Chief Magodi, but left after finding that she was not at home.

The victim's health reportedly deteriorated while she was at the house. She managed to contact her mother, who rescued her and took her to Chasefu Police Station, where the matter was reported.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said police issued the victim with a medical report form before she was rushed to Kanyanga Mission Clinic, where she is receiving treatment.

Mr Mweemba said the case had been recorded and investigations were underway, adding that efforts to apprehend the suspect were continuing.

The allegations have not yet been tested in court. Zambia's Children's Code Act prohibits child marriage, trafficking and the exploitation of children.



Deputy Secretary to the Cabinet for Administration, Dr. Oliver Kalabo, this morning led a delegation of senior Government officials on an inspection tour of the ongoing renovation and rehabilitation works at the National Heroes Stadium in Lusaka.

79 rounded up for cyber crimes

By Ruth Kambita

Seventy-nine people have been arrested for allegedly hosting a newly established, highly organised network suspected of conducting cyber-related criminal activity at Evana Estates, New Kasama.

The operation which was conducted yesterday, prompted by a public tip-off, involved the Zambia Police Service, Drug Enforcement Commission (DEC), Department of Immigration and the Zambia Cyber Security Agency.

Those detained included 35 Ugandans, 11 Chinese, 10 Zambians, eight Kenyans, six Ghanaians, five Liberians, two Burundians, one Chadian and one Zimbabwean. Officers seized 73 desktop computers, six laptops, 140 mobile phones, five Starlink kits, two external hard drives, 10 new SIM cards and 75 passports, and recovered K21,490, US\$10,450 and assorted foreign currencies.

Investigators are probing the network's structure, scope and possible links within and outside Zambia.

They are also examining recruitment, accommodation and working conditions of foreign nationals detained; initial findings suggest some may have been recruited under deceptive circumstances and others had restricted movement, raising concerns about potential human trafficking or exploitation.

The Department of Immigration has so far confirmed six Ugandans were staying in Zambia illegally; verification of remaining foreign nationals is ongoing. All 79 remain in custody as investigations continue.

This is contained in a statement issued by PROs Godfrey Chilabi, Allan Tamba and Namati Nshinka.

'Too young for marriage'

By Alex Maboshe

Family of a 13-year-old girl from Maamba town in Sinazongwe District has rejected claims that she was married to a 20-year-old man.

The girl's 52-year-old grandfather reported that his granddaughter had been sexually abused by a 20-year-old male from Nanimba Village in the

same district.

Southern Province Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo confirmed the matter was reported at Maamba Police Station on 21 August 2026 at 16:57 hours.

According to police, the girl travelled to her mother's home in Nanimba Village on 7 August 2026 to spend her holiday.

On 19 August, her stepfather informed the grandfather that the girl had gone missing on the evening of 17 August.

The next morning, 18 August, relatives of the suspect approached the girl's family and claimed their son had married her. The stepfather rejected the claim, emphasising that the girl is a minor.

He then went to the sus-

pect's house, removed the girl and brought her home. She was later taken to Maamba for medical attention.

Police have issued a medical report form and opened a case docket.

Mr Namalongo said no arrest has been made because the suspect remains at large. Investigations are continuing.

Police have reminded the

public that children must be protected from sexual abuse and exploitation.

"A claim of marriage involving a child does not provide a lawful basis for sexual activity with that child," the statement said.

Members of the public are urged to report any suspected cases of child sexual abuse to the police promptly.

Celtic off to Lilongwe to fine tune for new season

By Benedict Tembo

National Division One Ka-fue Celtic leave for Malawi this week to go and fine tune for the up-coming football Transitional League.

Coach Carlos Sinyangwe said a 28-member team will utilise the outing to Lilongwe where they will set up base to bond as well give the players exposure.

“Preparation are going well so far. We beefing up a young team again, and the boys look very mach ready for the upcoming Transitional League,” Sinyangwe, whose team is in the Southern Stream, said.

The Crocs, who were last in the Super League in 2022, missed out on promotion by six points last season.

He said the technical bench was intact from last season but the playing squad has been reinforced with some new players to add depth.

Among the new players are five youngsters promoted from the feeder club Young Crocs - Isaac Mosen, midfielder

Zebbron Banda (centre back), Golden Changwe (right back), Lesa Mwape (right winger) and Chipi Siwewe (goalkeeper).

New players roped in from other clubs include Richard Simasiku, a centre back from Barts, and Kondwani Lungu, striker from from Malalo Police in Kasama.

The Crocs have released another set of players to other clubs as well.

The departures include Elvis Mulenga (loan) and Herbert Mutalange (out-right purchase) who have joined TotalEnergies CAF Confederation Cup envoys, Red Arrows.

Shadrack Mwewa has been loaned out to Mikalile with Jeff Chituka also being loaned out to Konkola Blades.

Roosevelt Ng’ambi too been loaned out to Nkwazi with David Chilufya trekking back to Luanshya to rejoin

Mbesuma Academy, so has Jonathan reverted back Red Lions.

In Lilongwe, the Crocs will play against some of Malawi’s top clubs.

They play Wedson Nyirenda tutored Nyasa Big Bullets on August 26, take on Red Lions on September 1 and

Mighty Wanderers two days later.

Airmen get a taste of the continental battle, go down in a fight against TP Mazembe

Red Arrows football club yesterday played against TP Mazembe and were handed a stern lesson in intensity and clinical finishing as Congolese giants secured a 2 - 0 victory over the Airmen in a fiercely contested international friendly match.

The match that turned out to be more than a pre-season fixture and attracted scores of fans, gave a real glimpse into the demands that await the Airmen in the domestic league and on the CAF continental stage.

From the first whistle, the contest was played at a blistering tempo. Both sides traded attacks in an end to end opening, with neither willing to retreat.

Red Arrows showed ambition going forward while Mazembe’s experience and composure provided a constant threat.

A late change to the Arrows starting XI saw Joseph Phiri ruled out after picking up a knock during the warm-up and saw Mandanji drafted into the starting lineup.

Nine minutes in, Ackim Mumba gave the Mazembe defence an early warning and powered beyond his marker before firing narrowly wide.

Mazembe responded with a dangerous free kick three minutes later, one that broke through the Airmen’s defensive wall but rolled just wide of goal.

The intensity continued to rise. At the midway point of the first half, Red Arrows came agonisingly close to breaking the deadlock. Michee had delivered an inviting cross and Godfrey Ngwenya rose highest to meet it. With the Mazembe goalkeeper caught off his line, the ball appeared destined for the net, only for a defender to produce a crucial goalline clearance.

Paul Katema then tried his luck from distance with a strike reminiscent of a classic Frank Lampard effort type but the attempt drifted wide.

Then came the cruelest moment of the half. Red Arrows had just been presented with a golden opportunity. Mandanji dispossessed a TP defender and raced through one-on-one with the Mazembe goalkeeper but the Congolese shot-stopper stood tall and denied him.

Moments later, Mazembe



punished the missed opportunity. A long ball forward, two swift touches and a clinical finish saw the visitors take the lead in the 36th minute. It was a painful turnaround, the kind of moment that separates promising football from a ruthless one.

The Airmen pushed for an equaliser before the break and came close again in addtional time when Saddam Phiri found himself with a golden opportunity but the chance went begging. Mazembe went into the interval with the advantage.

Red Arrows returned for the second half determined to respond but the visitors struck again in the 50th minute. TP Mazembe’s Nyembo latched onto the ball after a slick interchange of passes and unleashed a low long range finish beyond the reach

of the Arrows goalkeeper just outside the box.

The Airmen refused to fold and Head coach Chisi Mbewe responded with a triple substitution in the 58th minute, introducing Lazarous Chishimba, birthday boy Peter Kalota and John Pweto for Zephaniah Phiri, Saddam Phiri and Godfrey Ngwenya.

Kalota immediately injected energy into the attack, delivering a pinpoint ball into the box. Mandanji met it with a header but once again the finish drifted wide.

The chances continued to arrive, but the goals remained elusive.

Mumba was forced off after picking up a knock in the 75th minute, with Angel Lubamba taking his place. Lubamba later came close, heading over the bar from a promising position.

Five minutes of added time offered the Airmen one final opportunity to alter the scoreline but Mazembe held firm, who also had made a number of changes.

And if there was one message the Airmen should take from this encounter, it is simple, this is the level of fight they must be ready for.

The domestic league will demand consistency. CAF inter-club football will demand even more sharper decision making, greater concentration, technical switch, mental and physical courage and above all, the ability to turn chances into goals.

In the match, Red Arrows created moments. They threatened. They competed. But the Congolese giants demonstrated what happens when opportunities are presented to a side that

knows how to punish them. It was a high intensity examination against an opponent accustomed to the demands of continental football.

But for the Airmen, it was precisely what preparation is supposed to reveal. You cannot learn how to fight by avoiding the fight. TP Mazembe brought the intensity, the experience and the ruthlessness. Red Arrows now know the standard. The league is coming. CAF is coming. And the Airmen have been given an early taste of what awaits.

Ultimately, a defeat on the scoreboard but potentially, a valuable victory in preparation was all that Red Arrows needed in the friendly Match. On to the next!

AIRMEN

Elite Ladies report Arrows to ACC, FAZ for ‘proposing’ their players

By Benedict Tembo

Elite Ladies Football Club has reported Red Arrows to FAZ and the Anti-Corruption Commission (ACC) for unlawfully inducing their players with lucrative job offers in breach of existing transfer regulations.

The club has lodged separate complaints with ACC and FAZ Ethics Committee alleging ‘severe’ cases of illegal player tapping, contract manipulation, and abuse of public office.

The club has taken this decisive legal action following systemic, unauthorised approaches made to its contracted players by senior management and coaching staff of Red Arrows Women’s Football Club.

“These approaches

by-passed all mandatory club-to-club transfer channels and directly violated both domestic and international football transfer regulations,” Elite Ladies Chief Executive Officer Oliver Shalala charged in a statement.

Shalala said the Elite Ladies had submitted ‘explicit evidence’ alleging how public resources — specifically, military enlistment positions and government job slots within the Zambia Air Force (ZAF) — are being weaponised as corrupt inducements.

“These State employment opportunities are being used as leverage to coerce and entice contracted private club athletes into unlawfully breaching their active employment contracts to defect to Red Arrows Women’s FC,” he said.

Shalala said the formal petitions explicitly names

several primary actors for orchestrating these illegal inducements.

Among those cited are Warrant Officer Class Two Daniel Sibanda (the head coach, Red Arrows Women’s FC), Clementina Haamubbi Mazuba (team manager, Red Arrows Women’s FC), Major Carolina Fatuma Mungochi (the CEO, Red Arrows Women’s FC), and Lieutenant Colonel Zelipah Phiri (chairperson, Red Arrows Women’s FC).

“Furthermore, the club has cited Colonel Mutale Kasoma (ZAF Director of Public Relations and Foreign Liaison) and Lieutenant Colonel Kambani Ronald Lungu (CEO, Red Arrows Football Club) for administrative complicity, following their failure to act or intervene after the matter was officially brought to their attention for administrative

resolution,” Shalala said.

He said the use of taxpayer-funded government jobs to settle sporting transfer targets is not only an egregious breach of the FAZ and FIFA Regulations on the Status and Transfer of Players, but it also represents a gross abuse of public office under the Anti-Corruption Act of Zambia.

“This illicit practice subverts fair play, compromises the integrity of women’s football, and actively disadvantages ordinary Zambian citizens who rely on a fair, merit-based recruitment process into our defense forces. As a club, we will aggressively protect our investments, our players, and the integrity of the game,” he said.

Shalala said his club has compiled a comprehensive evidence dossier, including communications and statutory declarations, which has

been handed over to both the ACC and the FAZ Secretariat to facilitate immediate investigations.

“To safeguard the welfare, privacy, and psychological well-being of the affected athletes who were subjected to this undue institutional duress, the club will not be releasing the names of the players publicly at this time,” he said.

Shalala said The Elite Ladies remains committed to the lawful development of women’s football in Zambia and trusts that the relevant judicial and statutory authorities will handle this matter with the urgency and gravity it deserves.

By press time, Arrows were yet to respond to Elite Ladies’ allegations.